

# What other centers asked us for

A menu to react to — not a prescription. These are things **other APEX / SBDC counselors and their funders** told us they struggled with and wanted. You'll have your own ideas; this is here to trigger the ones you haven't thought of yet. Each is marked **live today** or **proposed** so you know what you can use Monday vs. what we'd build with you.

**LIVE** In Mindy today — usable now

**PROPOSED** Asked for by others — we'd build it

## WHAT COUNSELORS TOLD US THEY STRUGGLE WITH

Verbatim themes from an APEX center that scoped this with us (the pattern repeats across centers).

*“Clients attend training but don't complete the actions — we can't see where they drop off.”*

**Live:** a workspace per client shows exactly how far each one got (profile, targets, pipeline).

*“Each counselor does things their own way — the knowledge is trapped in people's heads.”*

**Live:** the Knowledge Base makes your center's playbooks searchable for every counselor.

*“We spend too much time hunting for templates — everything's scattered across drives.”*

**Live:** load your guidance docs once; ask Mindy instead of digging.

*“We can't prove our impact to funders — there's no tracking from activity to outcome.”*

**Proposed:** a monthly engagement + outcomes report built for grant reporting.

## HELPS HER → For the counselor

### Run every client from one seat

**LIVE**

Each business is its own workspace — its own pipeline, target agencies, and market research. Search across your whole caseload and "work as" any one of them. Import a whole roster in one paste.

*Every center that saw this wanted it first — it's the core of Coach Mode.*

### Your playbooks, made searchable

LIVE

A private AI over *your* internal guidance docs — "what did we tell construction firms about bonding?" Counselors asked for this by name ("Custom AI Workbench").

*Resonated most in the original quote: "private AI on THEIR documents, not generic."*

### See where each client stalls

LIVE

The client list shows how far each business got — so you know who to nudge and who's ready, instead of guessing from memory.

*Answers "we can't see where clients drop off."*

### Task & milestone tracking per client

PROPOSED

Assign and track the concrete next steps for each business (SAM done, cap statement drafted, first bid submitted) — a checklist that rolls up across your caseload.

*Explicitly requested: "task/milestone tracking," "activity dashboards."*

### Assign counselors to clients

PROPOSED

An admin view to assign each business to a specific counselor and see each counselor's book of clients — for centers with a team, not a solo.

*Needed once more than one counselor is in the account.*

### Standardize the "how we do it"

PROPOSED

Documented playbooks + templates baked into the workspace so every counselor works the same way — the fix for "knowledge trapped in people's heads."

*Requested as "playbook documentation."*

## HELPS HER COMMUNITY → For the small businesses she serves

### Daily opportunity alerts

LIVE

Every client gets matched opportunities by email — free, forever. The volume play: don't miss what fits.

*The #1 gap in the original quote — the other vendor didn't include it.*

### Who's buying + who to call

LIVE

Market research ranks the agencies that actually spend on a client's work, then the buying offices and decision-makers there.

*Also missing from the other vendor: "market intelligence, who's buying."*

### Bid help + compliance matrix

LIVE

Bid/no-bid scoring, every "shall" pulled into a matrix, a drafted first response, and a .docx export — so a client's first bid isn't a blank page.

*Maps to their "Proposal Response Basics" client journey.*

### Recompetes + forecasts + teaming

LIVE

What's expiring (recompete targets), what's coming (forecasts), and who to team with (contractor database) — all missing from the other quote.

*The full "what they didn't include" list — MI fills it.*

### Guided client journeys (structured paths, not a blank tool)

PROPOSED

Other centers asked for step-by-step paths a client walks on their own. Mindy already has three (profile → find customers → first bid); centers asked for these five:

A

#### New Entrant Readiness

SAM → compliance → capability statement

B

#### Set-Aside Path

WOSB / HUBZone cert → targeting

C

#### CMMC Level 1 Readiness

Cyber baseline for DoD work

D

#### Proposal Basics

First response, done right  
(live)

E

#### Subcontracting Match

Find a prime to team with

*The exact 5 journeys an APEX center scoped. D exists today; the rest we'd build.*

## HELPS HER FUNDERS → For the grant / funder story

### Monthly engagement & outcomes report

PROPOSED

The one every center circled: an automatic report showing clients served, actions completed, opportunities pursued, and contracts won — the activity-to-outcome trail funders ask for. Today Mindy captures the underlying activity (signups, profile completion, app usage, pipeline); the funder-ready report is the packaging on top.

*Requested as "monthly report on client engagement — data for their grants."*

### White-label as NCMBC's own

PROPOSED

Your name, your logo, your colors — the tool presents as NCMBC's platform, not a third party. Reports go out white-labeled too.

*Enterprise "white-label reports" — asked for by centers pitching their board.*

### Drop-off & ROI dashboard

PROPOSED

Where clients stall, conversion from training to action, and outcomes — the numbers that prove the center is working, at a glance.

*Directly answers "no tracking of activity → outcomes."*

**The funder angle is the wedge.** Every center said the same thing: they can deliver help all day, but they can't *prove* it to the people who fund them. Whoever solves the reporting story becomes indispensable — this is the feature most likely to unlock budget. Worth asking NCMBC what her funder actually requires in a report.

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## Questions to spark her own ideas

- ? What does your **funder** actually require you to report — and how do you produce it today?
- ? Where do **most clients stall**? (If we could surface that automatically, would it change how you counsel?)
- ? If your **whole team** could see every client's status in one place, what would that change?
- ? Which of your **own playbooks** would be most valuable to make searchable for every counselor?
- ? Of the five client journeys — which does **your community** need most? (New entrant? Set-aside? CMMC?)

Live = usable Monday · Proposed = requested by other centers, built with you · sources: APEX Illinois scoping + community BD plan